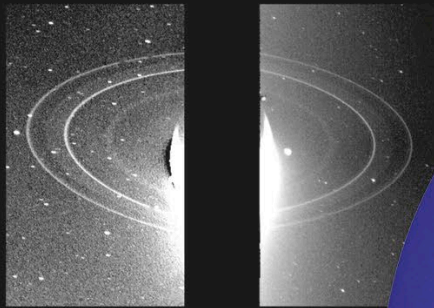


Neptune

A blue planet, Neptune is named after the ancient Roman god of the sea. Neptune takes 165 Earth years to orbit the Sun. So, since its discovery in 1846, it has only completed one full orbit.



These two pictures show the rings of Neptune. The planet has at least four faint rings made up of dust particles.

Neptune is a very cold planet. This isn't surprising as it is 30 times farther away from the Sun than the Earth. From Neptune, the Sun probably looks like a very, very bright star.

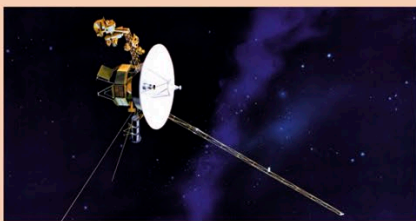
Neptune's moons

Neptune has 14 known moons. Its largest moon, Triton, is bitterly cold and has a heavily pitted surface as well as active volcano-like eruptions.

A day on Neptune lasts 16 hours 7 minutes.

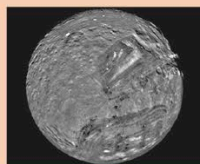
Big storm

Neptune is incredibly stormy. In 1989, *Voyager 2* discovered a storm the size of the Earth on Neptune's surface. The storm lasted several years.



Pictures from space

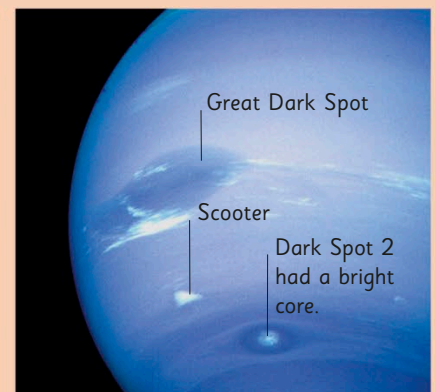
Voyager 2 has flown past both Uranus (in 1986) and Neptune (in 1989). It discovered ten of Uranus's moons and six of Neptune's. Most information had to be gathered in just a few hours as it sped on its way.



Miranda (one of Uranus's moons)



Titania (one of Uranus's moons)



This picture of Neptune, taken by *Voyager 2* in 1989, shows two dark storms (the Dark Spots) and the fast-moving cloud Scooter. Both of the Dark Spots have now disappeared.